

critical enterprise applications may require higher uptime. This prompts enterprises to look at multi-regional deployment plans for their applications. However, such plans incur added costs like additional infrastructure, cross-regional data replication and transfer, etc. Therefore, enterprises must make informed decisions and plan for only mission-critical applications and services for multi-regional deployments. Even with a multi-regional plan, based on the recovery time objective (RTO) metrics, they must decide on whether applications will go with hot-hot or hot-warm configurations across the regions. Hot-hot configurations incur higher costs due to additional infrastructure running in the resiliency region.

Monitoring the results

When applying the optimisation strategies, it is important to monitor the results to ensure we are achieving what we want. GCP's 'Cloud Monitoring Reports' provide a detailed break-up of costs for each service, where results are available with daily granularity even up to the last day. This allows us to track the effectiveness of the changes made for optimisation.

Once optimal costs are achieved, alerts must be set up based on current and projected near-term costs to detect significant increases beyond expectations. This allows for informed decision-making and planning for the next iteration of analysis and optimisation as needed.

Cloud computing provides significant flexibility to enterprises by eliminating infrastructure bottlenecks and providing managed services for faster development and delivery. This helps organisations to

be nimble, innovative and react fast to market and customer needs. However, there is no such thing as a free lunch. Every cloud service comes with its associated costs. Therefore, organisations and every individual within it must be mindful of the costs associated with every step that's taken, making informed decisions to control and optimise cloud expenses. This keeps the organisation's finances in the green, while also allowing the teams to leverage the full capabilities of the cloud. **END** 

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Scalability: Applications can scale infinitely by adopting a hybrid cloud strategy while keeping the core of the business and data secure through on-premises hosting. When an enterprise's demand exceeds the capacity of the physical data centre, it can transfer the data to the public cloud to access extra capacity and scale.

Disaster recovery and business continuity: Hybrid clouds enable enterprises to create robust disaster recovery plans by replicating data and applications across multiple environments.

More and more enterprises are embracing a hybrid cloud model as part of IT strategy. However, to fully realise

the potential of hybrid cloud adoption enterprises must carefully navigate the challenges such as complexity, security, and the required skillsets.

A hybrid cloud is not just about delivering cost savings. It is about

the enterprise becoming more agile, efficient and productive. The good news is that enterprises of any size can adopt a hybrid cloud model for cost-efficient delivery of business applications. **END** 

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